



GDD 59

If, When & Whether

Whether, when, and how many, is yours to decide.

The reproductive-decision heart of Chapter 7, the adult version of My Choices (g29). It supports deciding whether to have children, when, and how many, with honest fertility awareness and preconception facts, a compassionate and realistic look at infertility, and a firm stand against pressure, son-preference and the weaponised fertility clock. Calm, not panicked; childfree and many paths equally valid; medically accurate, never medical advice. Seven mechanics, 23 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Whether. When. How many. Yours.

If, When & Whether is the adult reproductive-planning node. It supports couples and individuals deciding whether to have children, when, and how many, with accurate fertility awareness, preconception health, and honest information about infertility and the options and their realities. It is comprehensive, frank and free of pressure in any direction: childfree is a complete life, those who want children are equally supported, fertility facts are calm tools rather than scare tactics, and son-preference and sex-selection (illegal under the PCPNDT Act) are confronted. New v2 build, the SRH thread carried into the biggest reproductive decision of adult life.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g59 · if-when-whether (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 7 · 22 → first child · adult / honest / calm, non-coercive
Thread / topics	F · Sexual & Reproductive Health · UNESCO 8.1, 6.2, 6.3
Prerequisite / builds on	g58 · builds on g29 (My Choices) · pairs with g60 (Many Ways to Family)
Gating	Open · no pressure either way; not medical advice
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the if-when-whether game.

84 scenarios	7 mechanics	21 myth-flips	23 choice & voice	0% binary taps
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No pressure toward children, none against, just your honest, free choice. Whether to have children is a real decision, not a default, and a childfree life is complete. Fertility facts are calm planning tools, not a weaponised clock: fertility declines gradually with age (sooner for women, somewhat for men), conception can take months, and preconception health and folic acid matter. Infertility is common, around 1 in 6, affecting men and women roughly equally and never a shame, with honest options and Many Ways to Family (g60) alongside. And son-preference and sex-selection are unjust and illegal under the PCPNDT Act.

The question everyone but you has answered.

From the Chapter 7 personas (22 onward). Adults facing the question of children that everyone but them seems to have answered, who need honest fertility and options information free of panic, permission for "not yet", "never" or "another way", and a shield against the "good news" and son-preference pressure.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Sneha (the timeline)	That childfree is complete, and the clock isn't a weapon.	strike-rewrite + reflect: whether & why.
Pooja & Karthik	Calm, shared fertility facts and timing on their terms.	branch + role-play: fertility, when.
Reshma (low-income)	Compassion and realism on infertility, no shame.	sort + branch: if it's hard.
Razia	To confront son-preference and the "good news" pressure.	strike-rewrite + match: free of pressure.

Why this works (the evidence). Whether, when and how many is a genuine choice, no pressure either way: childfree is complete, readiness is honest reflection not perfection, and the decision belongs to those who live it. Honest fertility awareness is a calm tool: fertility declines gradually with age (faster for women after the mid-30s, somewhat for men), conception can take months, and folic acid before and in early pregnancy cuts certain birth defects sharply. Infertility is common (about 1 in 6) and roughly equal between the sexes, male factors in about a third or more of cases, with treatments that help many but aren't guaranteed. Son-preference is unjust and sex selection is illegal under the PCPNDT Act 1994. It is general information, not medical advice.

Seven moves, led by the flip and the choice.

It's a decision game, so **strike-rewrite** leads (clearing the reproductive myths, panic and shame) alongside **branch** (choose the calm, informed, autonomous move), with **sort** drawing the lines (fact vs panic, support vs pressure); **role-play** gives the words for the boundary and the partner talk. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE ADULT DOES	EMBODIES	N
strike-rewrite signature	Busts a reproductive myth, panic or shame.	Conceptual change.	21
branch (the choice) signature	Chooses the calm, informed, autonomous move.	Judgement.	13
reflect	Internalises autonomy, calm facts and freedom from pressure.	Values.	12
sort	Sorts fact vs panic; support vs pressure; truth vs myth.	The line.	11
match	Pairs a fertility basic to its meaning; a pressure line to a calm reply.	Connections.	10
role-play (voice)	Holds a boundary; reassures; talks timing with a partner.	Voice; care.	10
spot	Spots the honest message; pressure dressed as care.	Reading it.	7

23 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it engaging?

Game feel is relief and agency at a question loaded with pressure: the calm of honest facts instead of panic, the freedom of being told every answer (yes, no, not yet, another way) is valid, and the strength of a boundary that holds against the "good news" chorus. The "oh, this is actually mine to decide" moment lands repeatedly. Sam is a warm adult peer; the tone is honest and gentle, never preachy, and it pushes no answer in any direction, and it never uses scare tactics or false hope.

Is it teaching?

Yes: approaching the whether/when/how-many decision deliberately and together; understanding fertility awareness and preconception health calmly; understanding infertility and the options and their realities with compassion; and resisting external pressure, including son-preference and sex-selection, on a deeply personal choice.

The belief it moves. From "children are the default; there's always time; it just happens; infertility is rare and her fault; family decides; you must keep trying for a son" → "children are a real choice; fertility is worth knowing calmly; conception takes time; infertility is common and no one's fault; the couple decides; and every child is valued equally."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the whether → fertility → when & spacing → if-it's-hard → free-of-pressure → tools arc, India-grounded, calm and non-coercive. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
Whether & why	14	strike-rewrite, reflect, sort	A real choice, not a default; childfree is complete.
Fertility, for real	14	strike-rewrite, sort, match	Calm facts; age; the window; preconception; no panic.
When & how many	14	strike-rewrite, sort, role-play	Timing, readiness, spacing; your own timeline.
If it's hard	14	strike-rewrite, branch, sort	Infertility with compassion; options; no shame; g60.
Free of pressure	14	strike-rewrite, match, branch	Autonomy; son-preference & PCPNDT; the clock.
Tools & help	14	role-play, sort, match	Reflection tool, fertility basics, RKSK, clinicians.

The 'always time' flip + the infertility flip, verbatim.

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flip: "There's always plenty of time; fertility doesn't change with age."
UN -> "There's always time; fertility doesn't change with age."
RE -> "Fertility declines gradually with age, sooner for women and
      somewhat for men, so it's worth knowing, calmly, for planning."

flip: "Infertility is rare and always the woman's fault."
UN -> "Infertility is rare and always the woman's fault."
RE -> "Infertility is common (about 1 in 6) and involves men and women
      roughly equally; it isn't a woman's fault."
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Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 59 If When and Whether — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
Having children is just what everyone does; not a choice.	Whether to have children is a genuine, personal choice.	Whether is real.
A woman who doesn't want children is selfish or incomplete.	Childfree is a valid, complete life; womanhood isn't motherhood.	Childfree is complete.
There's always time; fertility doesn't change with age.	Fertility declines gradually with age; worth knowing calmly.	Age, calmly.
Fertility 'awareness' is just scaring women into rushing.	Honest facts are calm planning tools you own, never scare tactics.	Facts not fear.
Infertility is rare and always the woman's fault.	It's common (about 1 in 6) and roughly equal between the sexes.	Common, not her fault.
IVF is a guaranteed fix, nothing to think through.	Treatments help many but aren't guaranteed; honest expectations matter.	Honest hope.
It's the family's right to decide when you have children.	Whether and when is the couple's own decision.	Couple decides.
You must keep trying until you have a son.	Every child is valued equally; sex selection is illegal in India.	No son-preference.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam (adult peer) surfaces a real moment, a "when's the good news?", a fertility scare post, a hard result, son-preference.
2. **Choose or voice.** The adult chooses the calm, informed, autonomous move (branch), or finds the words (role-play).
3. **The flip.** UN busts a reproductive myth, panic or shame; RE writes the calm, autonomous truth.
4. **Reflect & plan.** Whether, when and how many, weighed on your wishes, readiness and honest facts.
5. **Support & routes.** Infertility and pressure route to compassion, clinicians, RKSK, and Many Ways to Family (g60).
6. **Sticker.** The If, When & Whether badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **whether question** and the **calm fertility facts**. It carries My Choices (g29) into adult reproductive life, and pairs with Many Ways to Family (g60) for everyone whose path to family is non-default.

No pressure either way; accurate, never alarmist.

- **No pressure toward children or against.** The node supports the decision without pushing any answer; childfree and many-paths-to-parenthood are equally valid.
- **Accurate but panic-free.** Fertility and age facts are presented calmly as planning tools, never as scare tactics or a weaponised clock; it's a both-partners matter, not only a woman's.
- **Infertility with compassion.** Common, roughly equal between the sexes, no shame; options are honest, with no false promises; family is whole in many forms.
- **Son-preference confronted.** Prenatal sex determination and sex selection are illegal under the PCPNDT Act; every child is valued equally.
- **Not medical advice.** General information to help you think and ask better questions; medically accurate and expert-reviewed, pointing to clinicians and services like RKSK.
- **Routes onward.** Adoption and other paths are handled fully in Many Ways to Family (g60).
- **Access & privacy.** Self-directed, audio, offline, low-end build; no products, ads or real data; private by design (DPDP-aligned).

For real care and support (India). For fertility, preconception or infertility care, see a qualified clinician or public reproductive-health services (RKSK / nearby health centres). Infertility is common and never your shame. Prenatal sex determination and sex selection are illegal under the PCPNDT Act. Adoption and other routes to family: Many Ways to Family (g60). This game is information, not medical advice.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. if-when-whether** equals node.game equals GameDone key equals registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; the **strike-rewrite** myth flip and the **branch** autonomous choice co-lead.
- **No-pressure & accuracy are hard requirements.** No-pressure-either-way, panic-free accuracy, infertility compassion, and son-preference confrontation are contractual; expert-reviewed.
- **Fact-checked content.** WHO infertility (about 1 in 6; roughly equal sexes), age-and-fertility trends, folic-acid/preconception evidence, and the PCPNDT Act verified this build.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 25%, 0% binary, 23 autonomy, 21 UN→RE, 6 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run `score_gdd.py` on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Infertility and reproductive-health needs route to clinicians and public services (RKSK), with adoption/other routes in g60.
- **Tracked.** `build_gate.py` finalize advances g59 to v2 PASS only after order, read, score, audit and artifact gates pass.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): no pressure toward or against children; accurate but never alarmist; infertility handled with compassion and realism; son-preference and sex-selection confronted (PCPNDT); not medical advice; childfree and many-paths equally valid; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **It's a real choice, so protect it.** Because whether, when and how many is a genuine personal decision, applying no pressure and validating childfree and every path is what makes the node honest and freeing.
- **Calm facts beat panic, so teach them.** Since fertility and preconception facts genuinely help planning but are easily weaponised, presenting them calmly, for both partners, turns anxiety into informed agency.
- **Compassion and law keep it safe.** Because infertility is common and no one's fault, and son-preference and sex selection are unjust and illegal, handling them with compassion and confronting them plainly is what makes the chapter both kind and right.

Sources: UNESCO ITGSE Key Concepts 8 (reproduction) and 6 (sexual and reproductive health); WHO on infertility (affecting about 1 in 6 people, with male and female factors roughly equal) and on fertility and preconception care; evidence on age-related fertility decline and on folic-acid supplementation reducing neural-tube defects; India's Pre-Conception and Pre-Natal Diagnostic Techniques (PCPNDT) Act 1994 prohibiting sex selection; and MoHFW/RKSK public reproductive-health services. Calm and non-coercive, no pressure toward children or against, accurate but never alarmist, with infertility handled compassionately and son-preference confronted; general information, not medical advice. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 59 games now v2. Next by order: Many Ways to Family (g60).